

Somatostatin analogues for neuroendocrine tumours (NETs)

Somatostatin analogues (SSAs) are drugs that treat the symptoms of carcinoid syndrome. They can help reduce flushing and diarrhoea, and can slow down the growth of tumours.

Somatostatin analogues are a type of drug that works by stopping the body making too many hormones. You may have this treatment to:

- treat the symptoms of [carcinoid syndrome](#), such as facial flushing and diarrhoea – these can happen if a [neuroendocrine tumour](#) releases certain types of hormones
- control the growth of a neuroendocrine tumour (NET).

Octreotide and lanreotide

The most commonly used somatostatin analogues are:

- octreotide (Sandostatin[®], Sandostatin Lar[®], Olatuton[®])
- lanreotide (Somatuline[®] LA, Somatuline Autogel[®]).

These drugs are given as an injection. How often you have your injection will depend on how your symptoms respond to the treatment. Most people will have the injection every 28 days. The injections are given under the skin (subcutaneously) or into a muscle.

These injections may be given in the hospital to begin with. Then you may be able to have them at home. Sometimes the nurse can show you, or a relative or friend, how to do the injections. This depends on the type of injections you are given.

Your doctor, nurse or pharmacist can tell you more about what to expect from octreotide and lanreotide, and the side effects you might have.

Our cancer information meets the [PIF TICK](#) quality mark.

This means it is easy to use, up-to-date and based on the latest evidence. Learn more about [how we produce our information](#).

How we can help

Macmillan Support Line

The Macmillan Support Line is a free and confidential service for people living with and affected by cancer. If you need to talk, we'll listen.



Call us free on 0808 808 0000

8am to 8pm, 7 days a week. You can talk to our cancer specialists about anything.



Email the Macmillan Support Line

Email the Macmillan Support Team if you have any questions.

Chat online

Available 8am to 7.45pm, 7 days a week. For confidential, real-time support if you don't want to call.



Online Community

Chat online anonymously to others who understand what you are going through. Our community is available 24/7 and has dedicated forums where you can get advice and ask our experts.



Find cancer support services in your area

What's going on near you? Find out about support groups, where to get information and how to get involved with Macmillan where you live.

Get help

Date reviewed

Reviewed: 05 January 2022 | Next review: 05 January 2025

⚠ This content is currently being reviewed. New information will be coming soon.